



The story of Holes takes _____ in a number of _____ time periods: the present, Stanley's recent past and 100 years ago. We learn that the _____ has a huge impact on the _____, even if the characters don't realise it. Sometimes the stories of the past are told whilst the _____ continues to tell the story. You will see this in Chapter 6. This _____ is called a _____.

narrator different past flashback present place
technique

Why does the writer use different time periods to tell his story?

Today's objectives:

To be able to define the term 'flashback'

To talk about why an author might choose this method.

To discuss the problems which might occur when a flashback is used.

Read the first part of Chapter 6

Stanley took a shower if you could call it that, ate dinner if you could call it that, and went to bed if you could call his smelly and scratchy cot a bed. Because of the scarcity of water, each camper was only allowed a four-minute shower. It took Stanley nearly that long to get used to the cold water. There was no knob for hot water. He kept stepping into, then jumping back from, the spray, until the water shut off automatically. He never managed to use his bar of soap, which was just as well, because he wouldn't have had time to rinse off the suds.

Dinner was some kind of stewed meat and vegetables. The meat was brown and the vegetables had once been green. Everything tasted pretty much the same. He ate it all, and used his slice of white bread to mop up the juice. Stanley had never been one to leave food on his plate, no matter how it tasted.

TASK:

You are Stanley. Write your first letter home to your mother.

Explain where you have arrived (you might want to **fib** a bit to make it sound ok - she might worry if she knows about all the dangers!)

Tell her about some of the boys you have met (again, you might want to **fib** a bit to make it sound better than it is!)

Fib = a lie, but often with good intentions.

- **Use the scaffold on the next slide and write it into your books.**

Letter Writing: Stanley's Letter Home

You are Stanley. Write your first letter home to your mother.

Remember: You might want to *fib* a bit to make it sound nicer, you don't want her to worry!

Structure and Prompts

1. Greeting:

Dear Mum,

2. Opening Sentence:

Tell your mum how you are feeling and that you have arrived safely.

Example: I've just arrived safely and everything is fine here!

3. Describe the place:

Explain where you are and what it looks like.

Make it sound better than it really is! (fib(lie) a little)

Sentence starters:

- The camp is...
- It's really hot but...
- We have plenty of...
- The staff here are...

4. The boys you've met:

Describe some of the boys and what they are like.

Make them sound friendly and kind, even if they're not!

Sentence starters:

- I've met a boy called...
- He's really...
- Everyone is friendly and helpful.

5. Daily life:

Explain what you do each day and how you are finding it.

Again, make it sound more positive than it really is.

Sentence starters:

- Each day we...
- It's hard work, but...
- I'm getting used to...

6. Ending:

Finish your letter with a positive message.

Example: Don't worry about me, everything is going well. I miss you and hope you are okay.

7. Sign-off:

Love from,

Stanley

If finished early....

Read the next chapter or chapter in holes.